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A NEW OPPORTUNITY
Underlying the expansion is a demographic shift. Rising affluence, combined with globalised tastes and brand consciousness is pushing Indian buyers toward projects that offer not just square footage, but an entire lifestyle

During the Covid-19 pandemic, India's wealthy sought larger homes, second residences, and premium amenities, as global travel was restricted. This demand surge lifted luxury property prices and emboldened developers to consider branded residences, often in partnership with established hotel chains. For investors, the segment combined two trusted asset classes: real estate and hospitality. The formula—properties backed by the credibility of a Taj, a Marriott, or a Radisson—made the product both aspirational and relatively secure.

Though still at an early stage, activity is picking up in Mumbai, Bengaluru, Delhi-NCR, and Hyderabad. Delhi is home to the largest number of branded residence units with a supply of 915, including two projects that are in the pipeline. This is followed by Mumbai and Pune, home to 672 and 684 units respectively. Ahmedabad, Trivandrum, Goa, Pune, Kolkata, and Chennai are debuting this concept.

G LOBALLY, BRANDED residences are a tested model. There are more than 105,000 units across 750 projects worldwide. Hotel operators account for 80% share. The rest are with non-hotel brands such as Trump Towers, YOO, Versace, etc. India currently holds about 3% share, or about 2,900 units, and by 2027 the number of projects is expected to rise nearly 60% (to 1,200) according to NOESIS.

India's price premiums, 21–40% above comparable non-branded luxury apartments, are modest relative to markets like Dubai or Miami, where premiums of 50% or more are not uncommon. This suggests headroom for growth with deepening consumer awareness. For brands, the pitch is simple: consistent service, standardised quality, and prestige. For buyers, these projects serve as markers of wealth, investment vehicles, and lifestyle choices.

Hotel groups have been quick to spot this opportunity. Marriott International,